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HÖGSKOLAN DALARNA

Adventure Motivations in Motorcycle Tourism: A Study of Dutch Motorcyclists

Author: Sil Spiegelenberg
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Supervisor: Daniel Brandt
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Abstract

Motorcycle tourism has grown significantly in recent years. Despite this increase in popularity, this field remains under-researched in tourism studies. Although motorcycle tourism is frequently discussed as a distinct form of tourism, it has not been acknowledged and is still considered part of the broader segment of drive tourism. Still, previous studies have shown a strong connection between motorcycle tourism and adventure tourism. However, limited research has examined the motorcycle tourist's adventure motivations among different cultural contexts. Given the popularity and increasing number of motorcycle owners in the Netherlands, this study aims to examine the motivational drivers of Dutch motorcycle tourists to participate in motorcycle holidays.

This study adopts a quantitative study design. Primary data has been collected using convenience sampling, through an online survey distributed across Dutch motorcycle-related Facebook groups. The questionnaire included demographic questions as well as 14 motivation items based on previous research. A total of 104 survey answers were collected, of which, considering the criteria (Dutch nationality and having completed at least one motorcycle trip), 92 could be used for further analysis. The data was analyzed in the software program SPSS using descriptive statistics and exploratory factor analysis (EFA).

The findings show that "interaction with nature and appreciation of beauty" was the most important motivation for Dutch motorcycle tourists, followed by "maintaining physical and mental control of one's body" and "a change from routine of home or work". These findings suggest that Dutch motorcycle tourists are primarily motivated by nature, exploration, and the experience of travel itself rather than by thrill or competitive elements. Furthermore, the results support previous research indicating that engagement with natural environments and characteristics of the journey itself are central aspects of motorcycle tourism. The exploratory factor analysis identified four broader motivational dimensions underlying motorcycle tourism participation, with two factors demonstrating satisfactory reliability and the other factors providing exploratory insights into motorcycle tourist motivations. In addition, the demographic findings indicate that Dutch motorcycle tourists are predominantly male, middle-aged, and primarily travel to destinations outside the Netherlands.

This study contributes to the limited literature on motorcycle tourism. The findings have resulted in more knowledge about motorcycling motivation, as a form of adventure tourism, and in a different cultural context. Moreover, the findings also provide knowledge for tourism businesses and destination management organizations. Especially, by highlighting the importance of scenic routes through nature, which can be considered in developing tourism products for motorcycle tourists.

Keywords

Motorcyle; tourism; adventure; motivation

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1. Introduction

1.1. Background

Existing research shows that motorcycle numbers have increased steadily over recent decades. In the UK, the number of licensed motorcycles rose by about 45% between 1999 and 2014, and more than doubled compared with the mid-1990s (MCIA, 2015, as cited in Cater, 2017). In Wales, the number of licensed motorcycles increased by over 43% between 2001 and 2013, compared with a 19% increase in cars over the same period (Cater, 2017). These figures suggest a steady increase in motorcycle ownership over time.
In the Netherlands, a similar pattern is observed. In 2019, around 650,000 motorcycles were registered, increasing annually to 750,000 in 2026, representing a 14% growth over seven years. This increase is also higher than the growth in registered cars over the same period, which was 12% (CBS, 2026). These observations suggest an increase in popularity when it comes to motorcycling and support Ramoa et al.'s (2021) statement that motorcycle tourism is growing.

Furthermore, motorcycles are used more often for leisure purposes and are increasingly part of tourism activities (Ramírez-Hurtado et al., 2022). However, the concept has not yet been recognized as a separate tourism segment. For example, organizations such as the Adventure Travel Trade Association (ATTA, 2015) and the United Nations World Tourism Organization (UNWTO, 2018) do not explicitly classify motorcycle tourism as a separate tourism category. Currently, motorcycle tourism is often connected to or discussed as a subcategory of the field of drive tourism (Frash & Blose, 2022; Gronau & Hokamp, 2022). Drive tourism is defined as “travel by any form of mechanically powered, passenger-carrying road transport, excluding coaches and bicycles” (Prideaux & Carson, 2010, p. 3). Motorcycles are also specifically mentioned as one of the travel forms within drive tourism (Prideaux & Carson, 2010).

Motorcycle tourism has also been defined separately in the literature. Sykes and Kelly (2012, 2014) consider several elements when defining motorcycle tourism. First, tourism involves someone leaving their usual environment for holiday or leisure purposes. The tourist can be both passive and active, meaning that passengers are also considered. Furthermore, the trip does not require an overnight stay; day trips are also considered. However, daily transportation using

a motorcycle is not qualified as motorcycle tourism. For example, people riding their motorcycle to work or to do groceries are not considered. Lastly, they defined motorcycles by borrowing Morris' (2009) definition: “a motorcycle is a two- or three-wheel powered vehicle designed for on-road, off-road, or dual-purpose (on- and off-road) use” (p. 1). This definition is important as it explains what type of vehicles are excluded from being a motorcycle. In this case, it excludes four-wheel powered vehicles such as cars. However, motorcycles with a sidecar, which have three wheels, fall under this definition and are therefore considered in this research and other motorcycle studies that adopt this definition.

It can be noticed that there is a difference between how the tourist is defined by Sykes and Kelly (2012, 2014) and by the United Nations World Tourism Organization (UNWTO, 2018). The UNWTO (2018) defines a tourist as “a visitor (domestic, inbound or outbound) is classified as a tourist (or overnight visitor) if his/her trip includes an overnight stay, or as a same-day visitor (or excursionist) otherwise” (p. 10). However, according to Sykes and Kelly (2014), a motorcyclist going for a day trip is also considered a tourist.

Although multiple definitions of motorcycle tourism exist in the literature, this study adopts the definition proposed by UNWTO (2018). This means that travelers using motorcycles are classified as either tourists or excursionists. In case the motor trip includes an overnight stay at the destination, they are considered tourists. However, if they complete their trip within the same day, they are considered excursionists and will not be considered in the analysis of this study. Although Ramoa et al. (2021) consider both excursionists and tourists in their motorcycle study, this research argues that the UNWTO definition better suits this study, as it is more tourism-focused and aligns with internationally recognized tourism classifications.

Returning to the phenomenon of motorcycle tourism, this form of tourism is distinctive because the motorcycle is not simply a means of transportation. Previous research shows that motorcycle tourists often value the journey itself, including scenic routes, embodied riding experiences, and interaction with landscapes, in addition to destination-based attractions (Cater, 2017; Pinch & Reimer, 2012). This highlights the importance of both mobility and leisure experiences in motorcycle tourism. Furthermore, motorcycle tourists may travel using their own motorcycle across multiple destinations or travel to a destination

and rent a motorcycle there. Even the motorcycle trip could also be considered part of the destination (Sabato, 2025). Overall, this demonstrates the diversity and complexity of motorcycle tourism.

As mentioned above, the trip or movement itself plays a key part in motorcycle tourism. In tourism studies, the following dimensions often reflect the movement of tourists: needs, wants, and geography. The needs are hierarchical and refer to the basic requirements that are necessary to travel (shelter, safety, status, etc.) (Maslow, 1943). The wants of tourists explain why individuals choose to travel, involving push and pull factors (escape, nature, etc.) as discussed by Dann (1977). Lastly, geography includes opportunities and constraints that arise when traveling. This includes, for example, transferability and demand/supply of geographical elements (mountainous areas, off-road/on-road, etc.) (Ullman, 1954, as cited in Maity, n.d.). These dimensions are relevant in the context of motorcycle tourism. Motorcyclists may be driven by motivational desires, but likely also select the destination because of geographical features and psychological needs. However, this research acknowledges these aspects but primarily focuses on the underlying motivations of motorcyclists.

The motivations why people travel have been studied extensively in tourism literature. The concept is explained as the reasons that drive individuals to travel and influence their travel decisions (Dann, 1981). These motivations are shaped by both personal and sociocultural factors (Lundberg, 1972, as cited in Khalilzadeh et al., 2024). Studying the motivations will help to understand why Dutch motorcycle tourists engage in motorcycle tourism.

1.2. Research gap

Motorcycle tourism has grown significantly in recent years (Ramoa et al., 2021). Despite this growth, there has not been much academic research about this field (Walker et al., 2011). Some of these limited studies focused on the impacts of motorcycle tourism regarding sustainability (Gronau et al., 2024; Monteiro et al., 2025), while other studies discussed the connection between motorcycle tourism and adventure tourism (Scherhag et al., 2022; Walker et al., 2011). Only limited studies have focused on the preferences of motorcycle tourists (Cater, 2017; Ramoa et al., 2021).

Previous research by Ramoa et al. (2021) examined motorcycle tourists from Portugal and Brazil. They aimed to fill the knowledge gap regarding

motorcyclists' motivations for touring and to evaluate motorcycle tourism from the perspectives of adventure tourism and ecotourism. Their structural modelling confirmed that adventure tourism and ecotourism were the two main constructs most strongly associated with motorcycle tourism. However, the authors acknowledged that their findings may not represent the profile of all motorcycle riders, as the study was limited to respondents from Portugal and Brazil. They emphasized the need for further studies with motorcyclists from other countries to allow for comparison, more knowledge about different cultures, and to analyze motorcycle touring and its relation to nature attributes.

Furthermore, statistics have shown a significant increase in the number of registered motorcycles in the Netherlands, an increase of 14% over seven years (CBS, 2026). Additionally, motorcycling in the Netherlands is stated to have become more popular over the past few years (*Interesse in Motorrijden Naar Nieuw Hoogtepunt*, 2026). This study, therefore, argues that it would be interesting to analyze Dutch motorcyclists. Moreover, the Netherlands serves as a practical and valuable study area because the researcher is familiar with the local context and has greater access to relevant participants and data collection opportunities.

Lastly, this study argues that knowledge about the Dutch motorcyclists can be valuable for stakeholders or destination management organizations (DMOs) to attract motorcyclists. As Artal-Tur et al. (2019) explain, tourism can help turn remote areas into popular destinations. However, Sykes and Kelly (2014) highlight that more research is needed in order to better understand this motorcycle tourism phenomenon as well as the potential benefits.

In conclusion, there is a clear research gap in the study of motorcycle tourism, particularly within the Netherlands, where motorcycling continues to grow in popularity. Despite this increase, research on motorcycling and motorcycle tourism in the Dutch context remains limited. Moreover, this research contributes to the current literature, which encourages studies to examine different cultures to gather more knowledge, as well as to allow for comparison. Similarly, the findings may be valuable for DMOs that work with Dutch motorcycle tourists so they can better tailor experiences.

1.3. Research aim and questions

This study aims to examine the motivational drivers of Dutch motorcycle tourists to participate in motorcycle holidays.

In order to explore and better understand the motivational drivers of Dutch motorcyclists when choosing motorcycle holidays, the following research questions have been developed:

RQ1. Which adventure tourism motivations are most important for Dutch motorcyclists to participate in motorcycle holidays?

RQ2. Which underlying motivational dimensions can be identified from the 14 motivation items?

1.4. Research contribution

Beyond addressing a gap in the literature, studying motorcycle tourism contributes to a broader understanding of tourism as a social, economic, and environmental phenomenon. Socially, it provides insights into leisure experiences and motorcycle tourists' views on cultures (Cater, 2017; Sykes & Kelly, 2014, 2016). Furthermore, motorcycle tourists contribute to local and regional economies through tourism expenditure across multiple destinations or stops along the trip (Sykes & Kelly, 2016). This is supported by Cater (2017), who found that motorcyclists from the UK spend on average around 100 pond per day. Environmentally and geographically, motorcycle tourism research emphasizes the interaction between tourist mobility, landscapes, and natural environments. It shows how motorcycling as a mode of travel is closely shaped by route characteristics, scenic value, and environmental conditions, which in turn influence travel behavior and route choice across different geographical contexts. In addition, this and other research about motorcycle tourism may provide practical implications for destination management organizations (DMOs) and tourism businesses by improving understanding of the Dutch motorcycle tourist's movement patterns and preferences.

2. Literature review

This chapter reviews the key theoretical concepts that are relevant to this research. It will discuss previous studies and their findings, which ultimately serve as a foundation for this research. As this research explores the adventure tourism motivation of motorcyclists, it is essential to situate this research within the previous tourism frameworks. Therefore, this literature review draws on concepts from drive tourism, adventure tourism, and motorcycle tourism, together with theories of tourist motivation that help explain how these are measured and discussed in tourism.

2.1. Motorcycling tourism in tourism literature

The limited literature that has studied motorcycle tourism has mainly focused on safety, environmental impacts, and demographic research on motorcycling as a subculture (Walker, 2010, as cited in Ramírez-Hurtado et al., 2022). Additionally, motorcycle tourism is often viewed negatively in promotional terms due to environmental concerns such as the use of fossil fuels (Cater, 2017). However, Cater (2017) also sees potential for motorcycle studies, as they use less petrol than most cars and could therefore be promoted as a sustainable form of drive tourism. Since this research does not rely on promotion or funds, it is a great possibility to further explore this interest.

Motorcycle tourism, as already indicated, is considered part of the broader segment of drive tourism (Frash & Blose, 2022; Gronau & Hokamp, 2022). Especially as with drive tourism, motorcycle tourists experience independence and freedom through the use of their own vehicle (Shih, 2006). However, studies have shown several differences that make motorcycle tourism distinct from other types of vehicles. Pinch and Reimer (2012) stated that tourists traveling by car to their tourist destination will appreciate the landscape, while motorcyclists are more closely connected to the riding experience itself. Therefore, they conclude that for motorcyclists, the vehicle plays a more central role, and the experience of travelling outweighs the importance of the destination (Pinch & Reimer, 2012). Moreover, Frash et al. (2018) mention that motorcyclists also stand out because they are recreational riders, for whom travel itself is regarded as a sporting activity rather than just a means of getting from one place to another. The relation between motorcycle tourism and sport was also highlighted by Sykes and Kelly (2014), who argued for a relation between motorcycling and sport tourism.

However, as this research has to be limited in scope and is not interested in sport motivations, this field has not been further explored.

Also, compared to travelers in enclosed motorized vehicles, motorcycle tourists are subject to full environmental exposure, such as wind, rain, snow, and cold or warm weather (Broughton, 2007). This can increase potential dangers and requires more advanced riding abilities (Austin et al., 2010). Besides that, Walker et al. (2011) highlight the discomfort of riding a motorcycle, explaining why motorcyclists need to take some rest every now and then. Due to these physical obstacles, Walker et al. (2011) argue that motorcycling can be considered similar to an adventure trip. Moreover, given these physical, skill-based, and choice-related aspects of motorcycling, they suggest it is better to examine motorcycling as a leisure activity rather than simply a form of transport. This further supports the focus of this research, which examines motorcycling as a form of leisure and tourism activity rather than simply a mode of transport. However, as discussed in the introduction, the focus will be on tourists who engage in leisure rather than excursionists going for a day trip.

Overall, the tourism literature suggests that while motorcycle tourism is often discussed within drive tourism, it has proven to have its own characteristics. The physical demands, skill requirements, and emphasis on the riding experience highlight that motorcycling is much more than just a mode of transportation and is better understood as a leisure activity closely connected with adventure.

2.1.1. Forms of motorcycle tourism

Motorcycle tourism is not a single form of travel, but rather a set of distinct travel forms that differ in terms of autonomy, mobility, planning requirements, and the role of the motorcycle in the overall travel experience. One distinction is between tourists who travel with their own motorcycle, those who fly to a destination and rent a motorcycle, and those who join guided or organized motorcycle tours. In addition, motorcycle tourism can also vary by trip length, ranging from short leisure rides to extended long-distance touring. These different forms are relevant because they shape how motorcyclists experience both the journey and the destination. Although there is no universally accepted typology of motorcycle tourism, previous studies have identified different rider profiles and travel styles (Gronau & Hokamp, 2022; Scherhag et al., 2024). For example, Gronau and Hokamp (2022) identified rider profiles ranging from “individual long-distance riders” and “holiday overlanders” to “after-work leisure riders”.

Motorcycle holidays with one's own motorcycle are associated with a high degree of freedom and flexibility (Shih, 2006). Riders can decide on their own routes, travel pace, and stopping points, which makes this form of tourism particularly suitable for those who value independence. However, it also requires greater planning, maintenance, and logistical preparation, especially when travelling internationally. On the other hand, some tourists might prefer flying to a destination and renting motorcycles rather than transporting their own motorcycle. This can reduce potential barriers such as distance, transportation costs, and time. However, it may also reduce the sense of personal attachment to the motorcycle and the flexibility of the trip (Shih, 2006).

Guided or organized tours represent another form of motorcycle tourism. These tours often reduce uncertainty and risk because routes, accommodation, and sometimes even technical support are arranged in advance (Huang et al., 2010). For some tourists, this form of motorcycle touring may be more fitting, especially in unfamiliar destinations. However, guided travel also limits autonomy, as participants have less control over timing, route choice, and spontaneity (Huang et al., 2010). As a result, each form of motorcycle tourism offers a different balance between independence, flexibility, and convenience.

A further distinction concerns the length and intensity of the trip. Short leisure rides may be more spontaneous and locally oriented, whereas long-distance touring likely involves more advanced planning and stronger attention to geographical conditions and route characteristics. Furthermore, differences in trip length may influence how motorcyclists engage with destinations and routes. While some motorcyclists may focus primarily on the riding experience itself, others may prefer to spend time at destinations and engaging with local attractions and culture.

The various forms of motorcycle tourism have not been the primary focus in current tourism literature (Gronau & Hokamp, 2022). Nevertheless, the differences between the forms are relevant for understanding and making sense of the motorcyclists' motivations and travel behavior.

2.1.2. The Dutch motorcycle tourist

To understand the adventure motivations of Dutch motorcycle tourists, their behavior must be situated within the unique geographical, infrastructural, and distinct features of the Netherlands. Geographically, the Netherlands might

present a paradox for adventurous leisure riders as the country is highly urbanized and densely populated with predominantly flat terrain and an extensive traffic management infrastructure. While the Netherlands might have a well-maintained and developed road infrastructure (Ministerie van Infrastructuur en Waterstaat, 2025), it does lack the sweeping elevation changes, mountainous terrain, and remote landscapes typically valued by adventurous motorcyclists (Cater, 2017). Furthermore, the Netherlands might be argued to be a small country with only 4.2 million hectares (CBS, 2021). This means that for leisure riders, domestic riding might more often include day trips instead of including overnight stays.

However, this geographical limitation functions as a "push" factor that encourages Dutch motorcyclists to seek riding experiences beyond national borders (Dann, 1977). Especially with the Netherlands' central position and easy border crossing within Europe, provide motorcyclists with easy access to more varied landscapes (Ministerie van Defensie, 2026). Within a few hours, motorcyclists can reach destinations such as the Belgian Ardennes and the German Eifel, regions marketed for their winding roads, elevation changes, and scenic environments (Ardennen, 2023; Eifel, 2024). These destination attributes represent some of the "pull" factors that may attract motorcyclists seeking riding experiences that are less available in the Netherlands (Dann, 1977). However, individual motorcyclists are likely influenced by different combinations of push and pull factors.

This foreign or longer-distance orientation is also reflected in the Dutch motorcycle market. Registration data from BOVAG (2025) indicate a strong preference for large-capacity adventure-touring and sport-touring motorcycles. The popularity of models such as the BMW GS series and the Yamaha Tracer suggests that many Dutch riders invest in motorcycles specifically designed for long-distance travel, comfort, and versatility across diverse road conditions. These purchasing patterns might indicate the Dutch riding culture that extends beyond domestic recreational use and is closely linked to international touring.

Building on this international orientation, Dutch motorcycle tourists have the possibility to seek destinations that correspond with what Scol (2016) describes as mythical routes. These routes provide experiences that are largely unavailable within the Dutch landscape. According to Scol (2016), some of the most prominent European motorcycle routes include the Route des Grandes Alpes (France) and the Route des Crêtes (France), the Deutsche Alpenstrasse

(Germany), and the Stelvio Pass (Italy). Beyond these mountain routes, long-distance touring destinations such as Nordkapp in Norway are also highly valued within European motorcycle culture. Nordkapp is frequently promoted as a journey to the "end of the world," making it a symbolic achievement for many touring motorcyclists (Scol, 2016; Noordkaap, 2024). A map illustrating these routes, together with the Netherlands' central position within Europe, is provided in Appendix A.

The importance of international touring is also reflected in the trips promoted by the Dutch motorcycling organization. The Royal Dutch Motorcyclists Association (KNMV) actively encourages participation in international touring events. The 2026 Fédération Internationale de Motocyclisme FIM touring calendar includes events hosted across Europe, such as North Macedonia, Greece, Denmark, and Spain (KNMV, n.d.). Besides that, the KNMV also promotes events in the Netherlands; however, these events are mostly evening rides or day trips, as was already expected earlier in this chapter.

Overall, Dutch motorcycle tourism is strongly shaped by the country's limited riding landscape, which encourages riders to go beyond national borders for more varied and adventurous experiences. This international orientation is supported by easy access to various European motorcycle regions and is reflected in the popularity of long-distance touring motorcycles and international riding culture.

2.2. Motorcycle tourism as adventure tourism

Adventure tourism has been explored by various researchers from different disciplines. However, there is no agreed-upon definition to explain this category; adventure tourism is rather used as an umbrella term in tourism studies (Rantala et al. 2018; Gross & Sand, 2019). The variety in meaning also applies to the activities within adventure tourism; adventure tourism activities can range "from a walk in nature to a flight in space" (Swarbrooke et al., 2003, p. 4). This variety gives the indication that adventure is a subjective concept, where people have different meanings about adventure. This suggests that experienced motorcyclists might classify the adventurous aspects in their motorcycle travel different then less experienced motorcyclists. Furthermore, it also means that the interpretation of whether a certain route is adventurous relies on personal aspects. Someone from the Netherlands might see mountainous roads as adventurous, while someone from Norway might not, considering their different geographical background. Moreover, a different study (Janowski et al., 2021) mentioned that

adventure tourism often includes physical activity as well as risk, uncertainty, and danger. However, according to Gross and Sand (2019), extreme risks are not required to be classified as adventure. This difference suggests that the literature about adventure tourism is indeed not fully aligned on a single definition or qualification. From an industry perspective, the Adventure Travel Trade Association (ATTA) provides a more structured definition of adventure tourism, emphasizing physical activity, cultural exchange, and interaction with nature, thereby offering a more standardized framework compared to the variation found in academic literature.

Building on Walker et al.'s (2011) suggestion to view motorcycling as adventure, this research argues that motorcycle tourism can indeed be seen as reflecting the three components identified by ATTA (2015). This can also be viewed in the following examples that further illustrate the relationship between motorcycling and adventure.
First of all, motorcycle manufacturers market some of their motorcycles using the word 'adventure'. The motorcycle brand KTM produces several motorcycles designed for adventure, among others, the KTM 890 Adventure R Rally or the KTM 390 Adventure X (KTM Travel - Adventure Without Limits, 2026). Furthermore, they state that you will discover the true meaning of adventure when riding one of these bikes. Similar examples can be found when looking at other brands such as Honda (CRF11100L Africa Twin Adventure Sports) (Honda Adventure, n.d.).

Secondly, there exist events such as the Dutch Adventure Ride Experience, known by the name DARE. This event organizes a two-day adventure ride for enthusiasts and brings together like-minded people (Stichting DARE, n.d.). Moreover, several magazines and websites can be found that contain motorcycling adventure-related information (Scherhag et al., 2022). Both examples indicate that parts of motorcycling are already connected with adventure.

Furthermore, Cater (2017) supports this idea and states that to some extent, motorcyclists can be seen as adventure seekers. Additionally, Scherhag et al. (2022) studied the adventure on two wheels in German-speaking countries. They conclude that motorcycling can be regarded as a subcategory of adventure tourism. Moreover, they discuss different classifications that are present within

adventure tourism studies. The activities that are within the segment of adventure tourism can be classified into soft adventure and hard adventure (UNWTO, 2014). Soft adventure often refers to activities that are guided, less risky, and require minimal levels of skill (Beckman et al., 2017; Gross & Sand, 2019). The opposite exists for hard adventure activities, with high risk and advanced skills (Hill, 1995). However, Janowski et al. (2020) highlight that this classification has its limitations and that activities can often be categorized both ways. For example, with hiking, someone could do a 2-hour walk in a national park with clear paths and rest areas or do a multi-day hike in the mountains with steep climbs and carrying all their equipment. Furthermore, other factors such as weather, equipment, and facilities influence the experience and should be considered when categorizing the activity as soft or hard adventure (Janowski et al., 2020). However, Scherhag et al. (2022) classified motorcycle tourism as a form of soft adventure based on their findings. On the other hand, Janowski et al.'s (2020) study found that adventure tourism is mainly shaped by what the tourists themselves experience and perceive, rather than just the features of the tourism product or what the industry offers. This supports the earlier assumption that had been made that adventure is largely subjective.

Overall, this suggests that motorcycle tourism fits within adventure tourism as a subcategory, but its classification remains open for interpretation due to the subjectivity of adventure. Consequently, whether motorcycling is perceived as adventurous depends less on fixed industry definitions and more on individual experience and context.

2.3. Motivations in motorcycle tourism

2.3.1. General motivation theory

Tourism motivation is a core concept for this research, as it helps determine why Dutch motorcyclists choose to travel and what factors influence their travel decisions. Previous tourism studies defined motivation as “a meaningful state of mind which adequately disposes an actor or a group of actors to travel, and which is subsequently interpretable by others as a valid explanation for such a decision” (Dann, 1981, p. 205). According to Lundberg (1972, as cited in Khalilzadeh et al., 2024), tourists’ motivations are both a psychological concept and a sociological concept. This means that motivations are both formed and influenced by personal feelings and society and/or culture.

Although motivations had long been studied in different disciplines, it was not until the late 1960s that the concept became a central topic in tourism literature (Fletcher et al., 2017). Since then, motivations have been an essential component of tourism studies (Pearce & Packer, 2013). In the years after, several theories and models have been introduced as part of the motivation concept, among others, the push and pull theory by Dann (1977), escapism by Iso-Ahola (1982), and the travel career ladder theory by Pearce (1991).

As discussed above, current tourism research includes many different tourism theories and models. The push-pull theory is a model that is commonly used in the literature (Duong et al., 2023). This framework suggests that tourism motivations are influenced by both internal and external factors (Dann, 1977). For example, push factors could be described as internal factors (stress, escape, adventure), while pull factors include destination attributes (culture, nature, events) (Gavurova et al., 2023). Furthermore, this model has frequently been used to examine tourists' motivation in very different settings. To name a few, Karamehmedović (2018) focused on heritage tourism, Buckley (2012) on nature-based tourism, and Su (2018) on food tourism. According to Duong et al. (2023), the findings of these studies confirmed both the influence of the internal and external factors. However, the significance of each factor varies depending on the context that is studied. This means that internal factors could, for example, be more important for cruise tourism, while external factors are relatively more important for heritage tourism.

2.3.2. Adventure motivations

Since motorcycle tourism in this study is conceptualized as an adventure-related activity, adventure motivation studies are relevant to explore. Many studies about adventure tourism motivations have been conducted in developed countries (Buckley, 2006; Caber & Albayrak, 2016). Only a few studies have focused on developing countries, according to Ashraf et al. (2026), who examined the adventure motivations of tourists visiting Bangladesh. Moreover, adventure tourism motivations can be studied in a variety of contexts. For example, a study conducted by Giddy and Webb (2015) examined the environmental motivations to participate in adventure tourism, while Gürer and Kural (2023) focused on sport climbers' adventure motivations.

Limited studies could be found that examine adventure tourism motivations in the context of motorcycling tourism. Ramoa et al. (2021) also noted this limitation, particularly regarding tourists' motivation within the adventure tourism and

ecotourism context. Data was collected from Portuguese and Brazilian motorcycle tourists, which could be used to examine the factors that motivate motorcyclists and to examine the extent to which these motivations align with established adventure tourism and ecotourism constructs. The findings showed that travel experience itself plays a central role in motorcycle tourism. Furthermore, they found that motorcyclists value the natural environment and engagement with local cultures as relevant. Lastly, the findings indicated that, unlike many other forms of tourism in which the destination is the primary focus, the journey itself and the riding experience are essential elements of the overall tourist experience. Overall, this suggests that motorcycle tourism shares important characteristics with both adventure tourism and ecotourism, highlighting the experiential and immersive nature of motorcycle travel (Ramoa et al., 2021).

Methodologically, the study adopted a three-stage research design. First, it conducted an exploratory literature review of motorcycle touring and related adventure and ecotourism contexts, followed by the identification and coding of 29 motivational variables. An exploratory factor analysis (EFA) was then conducted to uncover underlying dimensions of motorcycle tourism motivation in order to link the observed motivational items clustered in relation to theoretical constructs from the literature. In the final stage, a confirmatory-descriptive stage to reduce factors and to evaluate relationships was used in order to examine relationships between the identified constructs and to refine a parsimonious motivational model. This sequential approach made it possible to combine exploration and testing within one framework, resulting in a structured model of motorcycle tourism motivations (Ramoa et al., 2021).

The study makes an important contribution to the motorcycle tourism literature by providing empirical evidence for the relevance of adventure and nature-based motivations among motorcycle tourists. However, the study's focus on Portuguese and Brazilian motorcyclists limit the transferability of its findings to other cultural contexts (Ramoa et al., 2021). Nevertheless, the research represents a significant step towards understanding motorcycle tourism motivations and provides a valuable foundation for future studies seeking to develop a more comprehensive understanding of the factors influencing motorcycle tourists' travel behavior. Accordingly, this study serves as a key reference point for the present research, which seeks to extend this work by incorporating the motivational perspective in

the context of adventure tourism and applying it within a different contextual setting.

2.3.3. Measuring adventure motivations

To operationalize adventure motivations in the context of motorcycle tourism, this study adopts the motivation measurement scale developed by Buckley (2012), who identified key motivational items for adventure tourism (see Table 1). These items are structured in line with the push–pull framework of Dann (1977), as previously discussed. Internal (push) motivations refer to psychological drivers of participation, while external (pull) motivations relate to social and environmental attractions of the activity, in this case, motorcycling.

Table 1. Motivations for adventure activities (Buckley, 2012)

Motivations for adventure activities	
Internal, performance of activity	
Thrill	Adrenaline/excitement
Fear	Overcoming fear
Control	Maintain physical and mental control of one's body
Skills	Using expertise to perform very difficult tasks
Achieve	Overcoming challenges to reach difficult goals
Fitness	Activity simply as a way to keep physically fit
Risk	Danger as a direct motivation
Internal/external, place in nature	
Nature	Interaction with nature and appreciation of beauty
Art	Perception of activity as artistic
Spirit	Activity as spiritual experience
External, social position	
Friends	Enjoyment in sharing an activity with others
Image	A change from routine of home or work
Escape	Enhancing how one is perceived by others
Compete	Competition against others

The internal performance-related motivations reflect the psychological and physical experience of riding a motorcycle as an adventure activity. These include motivations such as adrenaline and excitement, the desire to overcome fear and challenges, and the use of skill and control in demanding situations. In motorcycle tourism, these motivations are likely closely linked to the experience of riding in dynamic environments, managing risk, and developing riding competence over time.

The internal/external nature-related motivations capture the aspects of motorcycle travel in natural environments. These motivations include appreciation of landscapes, perceiving the activity as artistic or even spiritual, and the emotional connection to nature. In motorcycle tourism, long-distance riding through rural or scenic routes might place riders in direct and immersive contact with natural surroundings, making these motivations particularly relevant.

The external social motivations refer to the influence of social context and self-presentation in adventure activity (motorcycling) participation. These include sharing the experience with others, breaking from routine, social comparison, and enhancing one's image or status. In motorcycle tourism, group riding, motorcycle communities, and the symbolic meaning of motorcycles as lifestyle objects may strengthen these motivations.

Together, these dimensions provide a structured measurement of key adventure motivations by capturing both psychological drivers and socially constructed meanings of motorcycle tourism experiences.

Accordingly, this adapted scale was selected because it has previously been applied in a motorcycling study in the context of adventure tourism (Ramoa et al., 2021) and because it provides a strong basis for comparability across studies. More importantly, it is considered highly suitable for the present research context. In contrast to more general tourism motivation scales, this measurement scale specifically incorporates adventure- and activity-based dimensions, making it particularly relevant for understanding the motivations of motorcycle tourists.

3. Methodology

This study aims to examine the motivational drivers of Dutch motorcycle tourists to participate in motorcycle holidays. In order to achieve this aim, two research questions were developed. To answer these research questions, this chapter discusses the methodological approach adopted in this study, including the research philosophy, research design, sampling, and data collection process. It also explains the data analysis methods used to examine the motivation items and identify broader motivational dimensions. Finally, the chapter addresses ethical considerations as well as the limitations of the chosen methods and reflects on how these may influence the findings.

3.1. Research philosophy

This study adopts a positivist research philosophy, which is often associated with quantitative research (Easterbrook et al., 2008). Positivism assumes that reality is objective and can be measured through observable and quantifiable data. Hoda (2024) defines positivism as "a research paradigm or worldview that accepts that reality is definite, assured, and certain and that it can be studied through direct observations by interchangeable researchers, and excludes traditional metaphysics and theology" (p. 108). This philosophical stance is appropriate for the current study, as this research aims to examine the motivational drivers of Dutch motorcycle tourists rather than to explore subjective meanings or causal explanations in depth (Bryman, 2016). This study focuses on the relative importance of the motivational drivers (RQ1) and the underlying motivational dimensions (RQ2). Therefore, this research relies on observable variables (e.g., Likert scale items) that can be analyzed statistically to provide a representation of the motorcyclists' motivation. As a result, a quantitative approach using a questionnaire followed by statistical analysis is employed to ensure objectivity, reliability, and replicability of the findings (Bryman, 2016).

Ontologically, this study adopts an objectivist position, assuming that motorcyclists' motivation exists as a real and measurable construct independent of any researcher's interpretation. Although motivation is a psychological concept that is not directly observable, it is regarded in this research as something that can be measured through people's responses to questionnaires (Hoda, 2024).

3.2. Research design

This study adopts a quantitative research design with a descriptive research purpose. The aim is to describe and analyze patterns and identify underlying

dimensions within the data rather than to test causal explanations or relations, which makes a descriptive approach most appropriate for the research questions. Furthermore, this study employed a cross-sectional research design, which is also commonly referred to as a survey design (Bryman, 2016). According to Bryman (2016), a cross-sectional design "involves collecting data on a sample of cases at a single point in time" (p. 208). This means a 'snapshot' was taken of Dutch motorcyclists as data were collected within a limited time frame. Moreover, the choice of a cross-sectional survey design is suitable for this study because it allows for the identification of variations and patterns between survey respondents, rather than changes over time. For example, it allows the analysis of patterns between demographic characteristics and respondents' motivations. This makes the design particularly effective for answering descriptive research questions focused on 'what' patterns exist within the data, rather than explaining 'why' they occur.

3.3. Sampling strategy

The sampling strategies are fundamental to research as they determine the quality and credibility of a study's findings (Bryman, 2016). A probability sampling technique, which is commonly used in quantitative research, was preferred but could not be used due to an inaccessible sampling frame. The Dutch government likely maintains a database of all registered motorcycle owners, however, access to this information is not publicly available. Therefore, this research has employed a non-probability sampling technique: convenience sampling (Bryman, 2016). This means that the participants were selected or approached who were easily accessible, in this case, via motor-related Facebook groups. Moreover, Bryman (2016) states that "it is also important to recognize that social research is frequently based on convenience sampling, and if the approach is clearly justified and limitations acknowledged this can be totally appropriate" (p. 605). Therefore, this study suggests that convenience sampling is a justified approach. Nevertheless, the impacts and limitations this has on the study's findings are thoroughly discussed in the methodology limitations.

Throughout the whole research, this study aimed to have sufficient data by collecting enough survey responses. Especially as Shook et al. (2004) argue that at least around 100 responses are needed to draw statistically significant results. Therefore, this research has distributed a survey online to reach as many Dutch motorcyclists as possible. There would be an alternative to collect the data physically, but this would cost more time and may have resulted in fewer survey

responses. Nevertheless, when online responses would be insufficient, additional data could be collected physically.

3.4. Data collection methods

A pilot study was conducted prior to the data collection period. A total of ten participants took part in the pilot study. As a result of this, the survey questions and data outcomes could be analyzed. Thereafter, the data was converted into the software of SPSS, as this will also happen with the final data. Consequently, some minor adjustments were made to the questionnaire, for example, changing the formulation of questions or answer options. Besides that, a few more demographic questions were included for potential use in the final analysis. Overall, this study is convinced that with this approach, potential issues that could arise with the actual data collection were minimized.

After revising the pilot study, quantitative data were collected through an online survey created with Microsoft Forms (see Appendix B). The survey was open for a period of 3 weeks (from 16-04-2026 up to 07-05-2026) and remained accessible to respondents throughout this period.

A convenience sampling strategy was used, as participants were asked through motorcycle-related Facebook groups to participate in this study. This approach was chosen in consideration of the limitations of a bachelor's thesis and to ensure a sufficient number of survey responses. Some of these limitations will be discussed in a later chapter. Furthermore, the same data collection approach was used in similar motorcycle tourism studies (Frash et al., 2018; Ramoa et al., 2021; Sykes & Kelly, 2014) and was therefore considered appropriate and justified for this study.
The survey was announced in a range of motorcycle-related Facebook groups such as #TET NL, #Allroadrijders Nederland, #Motorrijders Nederland, #Motorreizen, motor-campings en motor-hotels, #Motorvakanties & Ervaringen in Europa, #Motorritten wie gaat er mee?, and #Motorvrienden Nederland.

To ensure the participant was relevant for the study, respondents were required to meet two inclusion criteria: (1) Dutch nationality, and (2) having completed at least one motorcycle trip. Only responses meeting these criteria were included in the final analysis.

At the end of the data collection period, a total of 104 responses were collected. All responses were automatically recorded through Microsoft Forms and exported to Excel and SPSS for analysis. The dataset was checked before analyzing it in SPSS to identify mistakes or potential errors.

3.4.1. Survey variables

The aim of this study was to examine adventure tourism motivations among Dutch motorcycle tourists, and therefore, the questionnaire was designed around Buckley's (2012) motivation measurement scale.

Additionally, descriptive variables were included to provide contextual information that could help in interpreting motorcycle tourism motivations. Age and gender were included because previous tourism and motorcycle tourism studies have identified demographic differences in travel preferences. Motorcycle type was included because different motorcycle categories can be associated with different riding styles, and to see whether the majority of Dutch motorcyclists travel with long-distance bikes. Furthermore, accommodation preferences were included as an indicator of travel style and comfort preferences during motorcycle holidays. Finally, preferred destinations were included to provide insight into the geographical orientation of Dutch motorcycle tourists, whether this is mostly domestic or international.

3.5. Data analysis

This study aims to explore and better understand the motivational drivers of Dutch motorcyclists when choosing motorcycle holidays. The quantitative data collected through the survey (n = 104) were checked for mistakes or potential errors. Thereafter, the data were imported into the software IBM SPSS Statistics.

Descriptive statistics were used to summarize the characteristics of the Dutch motorcyclists. This included most of the demographic data, such as age, gender, motorcycle type, accommodation type, etc. Moreover, descriptive statistics were used to identify the most important adventure tourism motivations that play when going on a motorcycle holiday. This could be done by examining the different mean values of each motivation. Altogether, this method answers the first research question about what motivation items are considered most important.

To address the second research question, an exploratory factor analysis (EFA) was conducted to examine intercorrelations between the 14 motivational items and identify underlying motivational dimensions. This means that the analysis tries to

find factors or clusters within the data based on the participants' responses. The same analytical technique was adopted by Ramoa et al. (2021), discussed in an earlier chapter, to explore the underlying dimensions of travel motivations.

According to Hooper (2012), there are a number of reasons why researchers may use factor analysis. An important reason that applies to this research is that the underlying dimensions can be used as input for further analysis, regardless of whether this next analysis will be part of this thesis. Further analysis could, for example, identify patterns between factors and demographics (gender, age) or other reasons to explain certain outcomes. Without factor analysis, the data is harder to interpret, and often consists of too many variables.

Exploratory factor analysis requires researchers to make several important methodological choices, such as selecting an extraction method, deciding how many factors should be retained, choosing an appropriate rotation method, and determining how factor scores will be computed (Parmet et al., 2010).

The factor analysis settings were based on the suggestion of Hooper (2012) and Gorsuch (1983, as cited in Brown 2009). The extraction method that was chosen is the principal axis factoring (PAF), a popular method in exploratory factor analysis (De Winter & Dodou, 2011). Furthermore, promax rotation was selected as it is a rotation method that allows factors to correlate. There are other rotation methods, but promax rotation is considered easier and quicker (Hooper, 2012). Literature also discussed the decision-making of rotation methods, which is used for better interpretation of the factors (Yong & Pearce, 2013). To determine the number of factors that should be extracted, the eigenvalue criterion and scree test were used. The eigenvalue is explained by Shrestha (2021) as “a ratio between the common variance and the specific variance explained by a specific factor extracted” (p. 7). The eigenvalue was set to 1, which is commonly used and was also proposed by Hooper (2012). Furthermore, the scree test is a different method that has been proposed by Cattell (1996, as cited in Shrestha, 2021). For this test, a scree plot graph was made where the factor extraction should be based on the point where an “elbow” can be seen (Shrestha, 2021). The scree test was only used for this research to verify the factors based on the eigenvalue criterion.

3.6. Ethical considerations

Ethical considerations are an important aspect of social research and are widely discussed in the literature. Bryman (2016) highlights several ethical issues that

researchers should consider. Diener and Crandall (1978, as cited in Bryman, 2016) identified four main areas: whether there is harm to participants, whether there is a lack of informed consent, whether there is an invasion of privacy, and whether deception is involved. For this study, most of the concerns are less relevant as this mainly applies to qualitative or more sensitive studies (Orb et al., 2001). However, as this study conducted a questionnaire, the ethical issues were considered. The participants were informed that participation is voluntary and that they can withdraw at any time. Therefore, informed consent was provided to explain the purpose of this study, what participation involves, and their voluntary choice. Only participants above 18 years old were eligible to take part in this study. Moreover, participant anonymity was ensured, especially as personal information is not necessary for the purposes of this study. Therefore, the survey questions did not ask for names, emails, or any other personal information. Besides that, the data was stored according to regulations by the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) as proposed by Dalarna University's website (*Dataskyddsförordningen*, 2023). Lastly, the results of the data collection were only used for academic purposes.
The information provided to participants regarding the survey, research, and its ethical considerations can be found in Appendix A.

3.7. Methodological limitations

This study has its methodological limitations. A random sampling approach would be ideal for a quantitative study, as this would strengthen the representativeness of the studied population to the wider population. As a result of this, the generalizability of the findings would be improved (Bryman, 2016). However, due to the missing sampling frame, probability sampling could not be realized. Therefore, a non-probability sampling method has been chosen that better fits the study, namely, convenience sampling. However, this negatively impacts the generalizability and representativeness of the findings as explained above (Bryman, 2016).

Additionally, the online data collection lacks control and is not random at all, which influences the generalizability (Bryman, 2016). Moreover, this study is aware of the fact that certain people might not be active on social media, such as Facebook. Therefore, it could, for example, be difficult to reach responses from elderly people who still ride a motorcycle or have previous motorcycle experience. Besides that, the possibility exists that people could fill out the survey multiple times, however, this research argues that this seems unlikely. This

especially influences the representativeness of the studied population to the wider population (Bryman, 2016).

Furthermore, considering other academic research, the sample size could be argued to be low. Especially since Ramoa et al. (2021) collected a total of 428 survey responses. However, their data collection took place over a period of almost six weeks, while due to the limited timeframe of a bachelor's thesis period, this time frame is not feasible for this research. Nevertheless, Cater (2017) collected and analyzed a total of 156 survey responses, which is already closer to the number of survey responses from this study. However, this limitation does have an impact on this study. Generally speaking, a larger sample size would increase the precision of the outcomes of a study (Andrade, 2020). This means that, with an increased sample size, the results of this research would be more precise and more accurate for the Dutch motorcycle tourists.
On the other hand, Holtom et al. (2022) show that survey participation is influenced by the researcher-participant relationship, particularly the difference in power or status between the researcher and respondent. Even though they mention that this power difference negatively impacts the quality of the data, this study argues that bachelor students have less established professional credibility or "status" than researchers, which may have created additional challenges in obtaining sufficient survey responses. Therefore, this research argues that around 100 survey responses can be considered sufficient for a thesis.

Finally, the primary focus of this study was on motivational drivers rather than travel behavior. Consequently, variables such as trip frequency, motorcycle ownership, travel duration, travel distance, and route characteristics were not included in the questionnaire. While these variables may provide additional insights into motorcycle tourism behavior, including a larger number of these questions would have increased questionnaire length and potentially reduced the number of responses.

4. Findings/results

This chapter presents the results of the survey conducted among Dutch motorcycle tourists. Of the 104 motorcyclists who participated in the survey, 92 respondents were included in the final analysis after applying the filtering criteria: (1) having Dutch nationality and (2) having completed at least one multi-day motorcycle trip including overnight stays. Responses that did not meet both criteria were excluded. The results helped to examine the motivational drivers of Dutch motorcycle tourists to participate in motorcycle holidays.
First, respondent demographics are presented, followed by self-perception of adventure. Thereafter, the results of the relative importance of adventure tourism motivations are examined. Finally, an exploratory factor analysis is conducted to identify broader motivational dimensions underlying the 14 motivation items.

4.1. Respondent profile

The results of the sample's profile can be seen in Table 2.

Table 2. Profile of respondents

Respondent Profile (Main Demographics)			
Variable	Category	Frequency (n)	Percentage (%)
Gender	Male	62	67.4
	Female	30	32.6
Age	Mean (Std. D)	54 (12.3)	
	Range	25 - 86	
	Mode	60	

Among the 92 valid respondents, 67% were male, 33% were female, meaning that no one identified as other. The mean age of respondents was 54 years, with ages ranging from 25 to 86 years. The mode age was 60 years, indicating that this was the most frequently reported age.

Furthermore, the table below (Table 3) shows the results of the characteristics of the participants. Regarding preferred travel destinations for motorcycle holidays, 71 respondents provided a useful answer to the question. The other 21 responses were either missing or unspecified, such as "I like to go to the mountains" or "everywhere I have been". However, from the 71 responses, Germany was the most frequently mentioned holiday destination (n = 13), followed by France (n = 11) and Italy (n = 8). The answers grouped as "Other" (n = 39) include a variety of foreign countries, as the Netherlands was only mentioned twice.

Table 3. Characteristics of respondents

Characteristics of Respondents			
Variable	Category	Frequency (n)	Percentage (%)
Preferred Destination	Germany	13	14.1
	France	11	12.0
	Italy	8	8.7
	Other	39	42.4
Motorcycle Type	Adventure / Dual-sport	48	52.2
	Touring	25	27.2
	Naked bike / Roadster	9	9.8
	Cruiser	3	3.3
	Sport bike	0	0.0
	Other	7	7.6
Accomodation type*	Hotel / motel	64	69.6
	Camping	54	58.7
	Airbnb / rental	19	20.7
	Hostel	10	10.9
	Friends / family	3	3.3
	Other	0	0
* Multiple responses were possible for accommodation type			

In terms of accommodation preferences, hotel/motel stays (n = 64) and camping (n = 54) were the most commonly selected options. Since respondents were allowed to select multiple accommodation types, the total number of responses is more than the number of participants. Together, hotel/motel and camping accounted for 79% of all accommodation options. Additionally, 17 respondents selected both hotel/motel and camping. It should be noted that the survey did not specify the difference between campsite camping and wild camping, which limits further interpretation of camping preferences.

For the type of motor that is primarily used for motorcycle holidays, the respondents could only provide one answer. The majority (52 %) travel with an adventure/dual-sport bike during their holidays. This was followed by a touring bike (27 %) and a roadster/naked bike (10 %). The sport bike turned out to be the least popular bike for motorcycle holidays, with no response at all.

4.2. Self-reflection

Table 4 shows the results of how adventurous the participants see themselves. Appendix B includes the survey questions as well as the Likert scale options that could be chosen. Thereafter, the options have been converted into numeric values, with strongly disagree = 1 and strongly agree = 5. The mean value of the 92 responses resulted in a value of 3.9, and the mode value is 4. This would mean

that, on average, the studied population agrees with the statement “I see myself as an adventurous person”.

Table 4. Self-reflection of respondents

Self-perception	
"I see myself as an adventurous person"	
N	92
Mean	3.9
Mode	4
Std. Deviation	0.813
Minimum	1
Maximum	5

Moreover, the difference in perception between males and females can be seen in Table 5.

Table 5. Gender differences between self-reflection of respondents

Self-perception, male - female			
"I see myself as an adventurous person"			
Gender	N	Mean	Std. Deviation
Male	62	3.77	0.838
Female	30	4.17	0.699

It can be noticed that on average, females agree more with the statement about whether they see themselves as adventurous. Moreover, the standard deviation is also lower in this gender group. This means that the responses are more similar to each other compared to those of males.

4.3. Adventure motivations of Dutch motorcycle tourists

The relative importance of the motivation items can be seen in Table 6. The items could be answered using a 7-point Likert scale of importance. Appendix B includes the survey questions as well as the Likert scale options that could be chosen. Thereafter, the options have been converted into numeric values, with not important at all = 1 and very important = 7.

Table 6. Descriptive statistics of motivation items

Descriptive Statistics

	N	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std. Deviation
Interactionwithnatureandappreciationofbeauty	91	4	7	5.62	.771
Maintainphysicalandmentalcontrolofonesbody	92	2	7	5.22	1.194
Achangefromroutineofhomeorwork	92	2	7	5.22	1.088
Enjoymentinsharinganmotorcyclingwithothers	92	1	7	5.00	1.301
Adrenalineexcitement	91	2	7	4.59	1.064
Usingexpertisetoperformverydifficulttasks	92	1	6	4.50	1.330
Overcomingchallengestoreachdifficultgoals	92	1	7	4.24	1.409
Motorcyclingsimplyasawaytokeepphysicallyfit	92	1	6	3.85	1.519
Motorcyclingasspiritualexperience	92	1	6	3.62	1.784
Overcomingfear	92	1	7	3.53	1.558
Perceptionofmotorcyclingasartistic	91	1	6	3.32	1.541
Enhancinghowoneisperceivedbyothers	92	1	6	2.60	1.604
Dangerasadirectmotivation	92	1	6	2.51	1.456
Competitionagainstdothers	92	1	6	2.11	1.296
Valid N (listwise)	89				

The mean values have been sorted in descending order, meaning that the upper item, “interaction with nature and appreciation of beauty” (5.62), has the highest mean value. On the other hand, “competition against others” (mean = 2.11) has been valued as the least important item among all 14 motivations. Furthermore, the standard deviation is visualized in the far right column. This number showcases how much the overall responses differ from the average or mean value. The value that stands out most is the motivation item for “interaction with nature and appreciation of beauty”. This value is the lowest value of all the standard deviations, indicating that most people answered almost similarly. In addition to that, it would be difficult to draw a conclusion from the minimum and maximum values. However, in this case, it confirms the low value of the standard deviation, with 4 being the lowest value and 7 being the highest. Overall, it can be noticed that most values have a lot of deviation and a difference between the minimum and maximum values.

Appendix C showcases the differences in the mean value of each motivation item by gender.

4.4. Exploratory factor analysis

After identifying the relative importance of the motivation items, an exploratory factor analysis was conducted. Since not all data is automatically suitable for a factor analysis, a Kaiser-Meyer-Olkin (KMO) test has been conducted as proposed by Shrestha (2021) (see Table 7). The KMO measures whether the data is suitable for a factor analysis as well as the sampling adequacy (Shrestha, 2021). The KMO value of the factor analysis of 14 different motivation items is .748. According to Hutcheson and Sofroniou (1999, as cited in Hadia et al., 2016), values between 0.7 and 0.8 are considered good. The KMO value of this study's factor analysis is in the middle, supporting its suitability.

Table 7. KMO and Bartlett's Test

KMO and Bartlett's Test

Kaiser-Meyer-Olkin Measure of Sampling Adequacy.		.748
Bartlett's Test of Sphericity	Approx. Chi-Square	435.775
	df	91
	Sig.	<.001

Moreover, the Bartlett test of Sphericity has been conducted. Bartlett's test of Sphericity checks whether the variables are sufficiently correlated to justify factor analysis. According to Field (2001) and Pallant (2013), values above 0.05 could not be considered justified, as variables are not sufficiently correlated. Since the value of Bartlett's test of Sphericity of this study resulted in < .001, the factor analysis can be considered justified.

Since the Bartlett's test of sphericity was significant and the Kaiser–Meyer–Olkin measure indicated adequate sampling adequacy, the data were considered suitable for exploratory factor analysis.

The results of the factor analysis showcasing the underlying dimensions can be seen in Table 8. The factor analysis extracted 4 factors based on the eigenvalue of 1. Furthermore, in SPSS, the principal axis factoring method combined with the promax rotation method was selected. These methods have been explained in the data analysis in the methodology.

Table 8. Exploratory factor analysis motivation items

Exploratory Factor Anlaysis		
	Loading	Cronbach's alpha
Factor 1		0.771
Adrenaline/excitement	0.416	
Overcoming challenges to reach difficult goals	0.808	
A change from routine of home or work	0.587	
Maintain physical and mental control of one's body	0.835	
Using expertise to perform very difficult tasks	0.730	
Factor 2		0.789
Motorcycling as spiritual experience	0.842	
Overcoming fear	0.546	
Perception of motorcycling as artistic	0.856	
Danger as a direct motivation	0.675	
Factor 3		0.605
Enjoyment in sharing motorcycling with others	0.620	
Enhancing how one is perceived by others	0.367	
Motorcycling simply as a way to keep physically fit	0.330	
Factor 4		
Interaction with nature and appreciation of beauty	-0.506	
Competition against others	0.745	
Extraction Method: Principal Axis Factoring		
Rotation Method: Promax		

The reliability of each extracted factor has been analyzed using Cronbach's alpha. This reliability analysis was used to determine for each factor whether the set of items reflects one single underlying dimension (Cortina, 1993, as cited in Tavakol & Dennick, 2011). The Cronbach's alpha values are visualized in the last column of Table 8, where values of ≥ 0.70 were considered satisfactory for research purposes (Bland & Altman, 1997). Thus, Cronbach's alpha value of Factor 1 (a = .771) and Factor 2 (a = 0.789) are considered good or satisfactory. However, the reliability score of Factor 3 (a = .605) is below the suggested value of 0.70.

Factor 4 must be noted as it consists of one item with a negative loading and one with a positive loading. This means that the values of the items in this factor represent opposing motivational orientations. So the more important respondents value interaction with nature, the less important they value competition against each other. As Tavakol and Dennick (2011) explain, reliability "assumes that unidimensionality exists" (p.54), and because the items in this factor represent opposing motivational orientations, internal consistency cannot be meaningfully calculated.

5. Discussion

This chapter discusses the findings in relation to the research questions. First, the key motivational drivers of Dutch motorcycle tourists are addressed (RQ1), followed by the underlying motivational dimensions identified through exploratory factor analysis (RQ2). Thereafter, some findings of the sample characteristics are discussed in relation to previous studies.

5.1. Adventure motivations of Dutch motorcycle tourists

Interaction with nature and appreciation of beauty is the highest-rated motivation. This finding is consistent with Ramoa et al. (2021), who also found that motorcycle tourists value natural environments most. This consistency across different national contexts suggests that interaction with nature and appreciation of beauty may represent a core characteristic of motorcycle tourism rather than a culture-specific preference. Furthermore, this supports the idea that motorcycle tourism is not just a transportation activity but an immersive tourism experience in which engagement with the environment is crucial. Furthermore, it may support previous arguments that motorcycle tourism differs from many forms of tourism because the journey itself is central to the tourism activity. Namely, the importance of scenery and nature suggests that value is derived not only from reaching a destination but from experiencing the route and landscapes during the travel.

The research of Pinch and Reimer (2012) could explain a different reason for the importance of nature interaction and appreciation. Compared to car-based tourism, where landscape observation is more passive, motorcycling involves a more embodied form of travel in which the riding experience plays a key role. At the same time, motorcycle tourists are more directly exposed to environmental conditions such as wind, rain, and temperature variations than tourists in enclosed vehicles (Broughton, 2007), which may explain the value of nature experiences for motorcyclists.

Taken together, the importance of interaction with nature and appreciation of beauty among motorcyclists seems to be clear among Dutch motorcyclists. This might also explain the popularity of Germany, France, and Italy. These destinations offer landscapes and other geographical characteristics that can not be found within the Netherlands.

Moreover, the other motivation items are less consistent with Ramoa et al.'s (2021) findings. This research found that Dutch motorcyclists prioritize "maintaining physical and mental control of one's body" as the second most important factor, followed by "a change from routine of home or work" as third. This variation in findings suggests that differences among cultures might exist. Nevertheless, Dutch motorcyclists appear to value control and escape from everyday life. This finding is consistent with Dann's (1977) argument that the desire to escape everyday routines is a key push factor in tourism. Furthermore, the greater importance of control over adrenaline/excitement suggests that Dutch motorcyclists might seek less risk than Portuguese and Brazilian motorcyclists (Ramoa et al., 2021)

Overall, the findings suggest that Dutch motorcycle tourists may be characterized as experience-seeking and explorative-seeking travelers rather than tourists looking for thrill/adrenaline during their motorcycle holiday.

5.2. Exploratory factor analysis

The exploratory factor analysis identified four motivational dimensions underlying motorcycle tourism participation among Dutch motorcyclists. While only factors 1 and 2 demonstrated satisfactory reliability, all four factors provide insight into the diverse motivations associated with motorcycle tourism.

Factor 1 is characterized by high loadings on maintaining physical and mental control, overcoming challenges, using expertise, and escaping from routine, while the loading of adrenaline/excitement scored lower. These items suggest that Dutch motorcyclists are motivated by opportunities to successfully overcome challenges while developing their motorcycling skills. The item "a change from routine" also reflects Dann's (1977) push-factor theory, highlighting the role of internal motivations such as escaping everyday life and potentially seeking personal fulfilment. Within the Dutch context, this may suggest that motorcycle tourism provides a way to temporarily leave behind structured daily routines while engaging in a leisure activity that requires concentration, skill, and active participation. One possible explanation is that riders value routes and experiences that are different from their everyday, which might also explain why most Dutch motorcyclists participate in motorcycle holidays outside the Netherlands.

Factor 2 includes spirituality, artistic perception, danger, and overcoming fear, suggesting that adventure is not experienced solely through physical challenge or

thrill. This supports Janowski et al.'s (2020) idea of adventure as a subjective and emotionally immersive experience. Within the Dutch context, this may suggest that motorcyclists attach personal meaning to journeys through scenic or culturally interesting landscapes that allow for spirituality. The strong loadings on spirituality and artistic appreciation indicate that the riding experience may result in reflection, emotional engagement, and enjoyment. The aspects of danger and overcoming fear might be integrated into the experience, so it allows motorcyclists to perceive their trip as meaningful and transformative, which highlights the immersive dimensions of adventure beyond competence or skill.

Factor 3 comprises sharing motorcycling with others, enhancing one's image, and maintaining physical fitness. However, the factor demonstrated relatively low internal consistency ($a = 0.605$). This suggests that the items do not strongly represent a single underlying motivational construct among Dutch motorcycle tourists (Tavakol & Dennick, 2011). Within the Dutch context, where group rides and motorcycle-related events are common (KNMV, n.d.; Witt, 2016), sharing experiences with others may provide social cohesion and a sense of community. Similarly, image perception and physical fitness may reflect broader lifestyle preferences within and outside motorcycling. However, the relatively low reliability suggests that these motivations may operate independently rather than as a single unified dimension.

Factor 4 consists of interaction with nature and appreciation of beauty, alongside competition against others. As discussed previously, reliability could not be calculated because the factor contains two items with opposing loading directions. Consequently, this factor cannot be considered a reliable motivational dimension and should be interpreted with caution. Nevertheless, the pattern remains theoretically interesting because it suggests a contrast between the two. The negative loading for nature appreciation and the positive loading for competition indicate that respondents who place greater importance on engaging with natural environments tend to place less importance on competing with others. This may suggest that Dutch motorcycle tourists primarily value motorcycle travel as an immersive and nature-oriented experience rather than as a competitive activity. This would also mean that Dutch motorcyclists traveling in groups who prefer to have interaction with nature likely do not care that much about competition among each other. This may potentially even benefit the joy of riding together.

5.3. Contextual discussion of findings

5.3.1. Respondent profile and characteristics

The findings showcased that the majority of the Dutch respondents identified as male (67%). Although the gender distribution was somewhat more balanced, a similar pattern could be found in previous studies. The sample of motorcyclists from England and Wales, in a study conducted by Cater (2017), resulted in 17% identifying as female, stated as a significant proportion. In the study by Ramoa et al., focusing on Brazilian and Portuguese motorcycle tourists, only 6% identified as female. Despite these differences, the same conclusion can be drawn that motorcycle tourists from the Netherlands are also dominated by males. Nevertheless, the number of female motorcyclists in this sample is noteworthy and should not be ignored. This study finds it difficult to explain this noticeable number of females. It could be specific to the Dutch context or the growing popularity among female riders. However, the willingness of females to participate in an online survey may also explain this distribution. Nevertheless, perhaps the Dutch context can serve as an interesting area to study differences between genders in motorcycle tourism.

Since data was collected through social media, such as Facebook groups, the reservation was made about older people being underrepresented. Especially since older people might not be on these platforms or encounter more difficulties compared to younger generations. However, the ages of the sample ranged from 25 to 86, meaning that the limitation might be less significant than previously expected. Nevertheless, it could still be that not every age group is equally reached and represented.

The average age of the responses (54 years old) suggest to be consistent with previous studies. Cater (2017) stated that the largest age group was between 45 and 54 years old, while Ramoa et al. (2021) found that most of them (80%) are between 30 and 59 years old. This average age is noteworthy as motorcycling has been suggested to be a physically demanding activity. Perhaps this leisure activity keeps motorcyclists in good condition, even though it was not ranked that high as a motivation.

Moreover, the destination preferences of respondents appear to support the geographical context discussed earlier in this study. While the Netherlands was mentioned only twice as a preferred motorcycle holiday destination, Germany,

France, Italy, and various other foreign destinations were frequently reported. This finding suggests that Dutch motorcycle tourists actively choose to go on motorcycle holidays in foreign countries. As discussed in the chapter about the Dutch context, the Netherlands is characterized by a relatively flat landscape and dense urbanization, with good access to neighboring countries, which offer mountainous roads, elevation changes, and scenic routes that are often associated with adventurous motorcycle tourism (Cater, 2017). When interpreting these destination findings, it is important to emphasize once again that motorcycle tourism is often route-oriented, with the journey itself forming a central part of the experience (Ramoa et al., 2021). As a result, respondents may have interpreted the destination question differently, for example, by reporting the furthest location reached or the country where they spent the most time. Still, the findings support the argument that the geographical context encourages an international orientation among Dutch motorcycle tourists.

The predominance of adventure/dual-sport motorcycles and touring motorcycles further supports the profile of Dutch motorcycle tourists outlined in the literature review (BOVAG, 2025). These motorcycles are well-designed for long-distance travel, comfort, and differences across road conditions (Honda, n.d.; KTM, 2026). The domination of these motorcycles indicates that respondents do engage in touring-oriented travels of motorcycle tourism rather than only short day trips within the Netherlands. This finding highlights and supports the popularity of adventure or touring motorcycles within Dutch motorcycle culture and their association with holidays in foreign countries.

Previous literature emphasizes that motorcycle tourists often value autonomy and freedom in their travel decisions (Shih, 2006). The popularity of both hotel accommodation and camping may reflect the flexible and independent nature of motorcycle tourism that is also visible in the Dutch context. The combination of hotels and camping may suggest that Dutch motorcyclists adapt their accommodation choices according to route characteristics, weather conditions, trip duration, and personal preferences. For example, motorcyclists may select different accommodation options throughout a trip based on weather conditions, comfort considerations, and practical travel needs. Furthermore, this flexibility may also be related to travelling on one's own motorcycle. However, as this aspect was not included in the survey, this interpretation remains speculative. Overall, the findings are consistent with motorcycle tourism being a diverse and flexible

form of travel rather than a highly standardized or structured form of tourism (Shih, 2006).

5.3.2. Self-reflection

The self-reflection about how adventurous people see themselves could not be found in existing studies. The data could potentially be used to find patterns among motorcycle tourism motivations and how adventurous someone perceives themselves. While this analysis is not part of this study, it has been found that the mean value (3.9) is on the upper side, considering the 5-point Likert scale. Accordingly, this may explain why Dutch motorcyclists have ranked "adrenaline/excitement" as important (ranked as fifth most important). This supports that motorcycle tourism can be seen as a form of adventure tourism.

The difference between self-reflection in males and females was also noticed. On average, females considered themselves more adventurous compared to males. This finding is interesting as motorcycle tourism is often discussed as male-dominated (Cater, 2017; Frash et al., 2018) while also being connected to adventure tourism (Cater, 2017; Scherhag et al., 2022). It may be that female motorcyclists identify more strongly with adventure, as participation in this segment requires them to overcome social and cultural barriers. However, since gender differences have not been the primary focus of this research this is hard to say. Besides that, the sample size of females remains low, making it difficult to draw significant conclusions. Nevertheless, it would be interesting to analyze, for example, gender differences with other motorcycle tourism characteristics in future research.

6. Conclusion

This study aimed to explore and better understand the motivational drivers of Dutch motorcyclists when choosing motorcycle holidays. Although motorcycle tourism is becoming more popular, academic research in this field remains limited. Existing studies have primarily focused on other cultural contexts, emphasizing the need for further research in different settings. Given the increasing number of motorcycle owners in the Netherlands, Dutch motorcycle tourists represent a valuable and relevant group to study, offering new insights that can contribute to the existing literature on motorcycle tourism motivation.

The findings indicate that interaction with nature and appreciation of beauty is the most important motivation for Dutch motorcycle tourists. This result is consistent with Ramoa et al. (2021), suggesting that appreciation of natural landscapes may represent a core characteristic of motorcycle tourism rather than a culture-specific preference. The findings also support the view that motorcycle tourism is more than a means of transportation, as the journey itself appears to be a central part of the tourism experience.
Furthermore, Dutch motorcycle tourists place a noticeable importance on maintaining physical and mental control and a change from the routine of home or work. While these motivations were also measured by Ramoa et al. (2021), the relatively higher importance in this study suggests that Dutch motorcycle tourists may place greater emphasis on personal competence and leisure-oriented experiences. It also suggests that cultural differences are indeed visible in the motivations of motorcyclists
Taken together, the findings about the relative importance of the motivations suggest that Dutch motorcycle tourists are primarily motivated by nature, exploration, and the riding experience itself rather than by thrill or competitive elements. In the Dutch context, motorcycle tourism may therefore be understood as an experiential form of tourism in which engagement with landscapes and the journey play a central role.

Moreover, the exploratory factor analysis identified four motivational dimensions underlying motorcycle tourism participation among Dutch motorcyclists. While only factors 1 and 2 demonstrated satisfactory reliability, all four factors provide insight into the diverse motivations associated with motorcycle tourism. Factor 1 reflects a motivation to challenge oneself, develop competence, and temporarily

escape from everyday routines. Factor 2 reflects the pursuit of personally meaningful and immersive adventure experiences that involve reflection, emotional engagement, and personal transformation. Factor 3 reflects social and lifestyle-related aspects of motorcycle tourism, however, this dimension demonstrated low reliability and should therefore be interpreted with caution. Factor 4 does not reflect a single dimension but rather reflects the contrast between nature-oriented experiences and competition. In other words, motorcyclists who are more motivated by interaction with nature and appreciation of beauty tend to be less motivated by competition, and vice versa. Overall, the findings indicate that motorcycle tourism motivations among Dutch motorcyclists are diverse and include multiple dimensions of the adventure experience.

This study contributes to motorcycle tourism research by providing insights into the motivations and experiences of Dutch motorcycle tourists, a field and context that have received limited attention in the literature. The findings support previous research that links motorcycle tourism to adventure tourism, as participants frequently associated their trips with elements such as freedom, exploration, and enjoyment of riding. By examining these motivations in a Dutch context, this study expands existing knowledge and provides a basis for future comparative research across different cultural settings. Practically, the findings offer insights for destination management organizations (DMOs), tourism businesses, and tourism planners. The strong appreciation for natural landscapes and scenic routes among participants suggests that destinations may benefit from incorporating these features into route development, tourism products, and marketing strategies aimed at motorcycle tourists.

However, this study has its limitations. First, the methodological limitations as discussed earlier. The use of convenience sampling limits the generalizability of the findings. Additionally, the relatively small sample size further constrains generalizability and reduces the precision of the results. Furthermore, as this study adopted a quantitative research design, it does not provide a deeper understanding of why certain motivations are valued more highly than others. Developing such an understanding would require a separate qualitative or mixed-methods study. Moreover, the study focused only on Dutch motorcycle tourists. While this was appropriate for addressing the research gap, the findings cannot be generalized to motorcycle tourists from other countries or cultural contexts.

Lastly, the exploratory factor analysis identified four motivational dimensions, but only two demonstrated satisfactory reliability. Therefore, the factors should be interpreted with caution and require further validation using larger samples and confirmatory analytical techniques.

Accordingly, several recommendations for future research can be proposed. Future research could explore motorcycle tourism motivations in other countries and cultural contexts. Also, as this study focused on motivations based on adventure tourism, other studies could focus on other contexts connected to motorcycle tourism. This will provide a foundation for motivational aspects in motorcycle tourism, but also allow comparisons between different forms of motorcycle tourism. Besides that, the relatively high proportion of female motorcyclists in the Netherlands makes this country an interesting study area to explore differences in gender.
Moreover, future research could look for patterns in how the importance of different motorcycle tourism motivations relates to actual travel behavior, such as destination choice, motorcycle type, and accommodation type.
Additionally, studies could do almost similarly for the identified dimension found in this study. For example, a regression analysis between the motivational dimensions and the demographic characteristics, such as age and gender.
Furthermore, the underlying dimensions of factors 3 and 4 in this study could also be examined in more depth in future research. For factor 3, additional items could be developed to capture social, lifestyle, and identity-related motivations more comprehensively. For factor 4, including more items related to nature appreciation and competition could clarify whether these motivations form separate constructs.
Finally, future research using larger samples and confirmatory factor analysis would help validate and establish the motivational dimensions identified in this study.

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AI-statement

The only AI tool that was used is the free version of Grammarly, which makes me aware of spelling mistakes.

Appendices

Appendix A

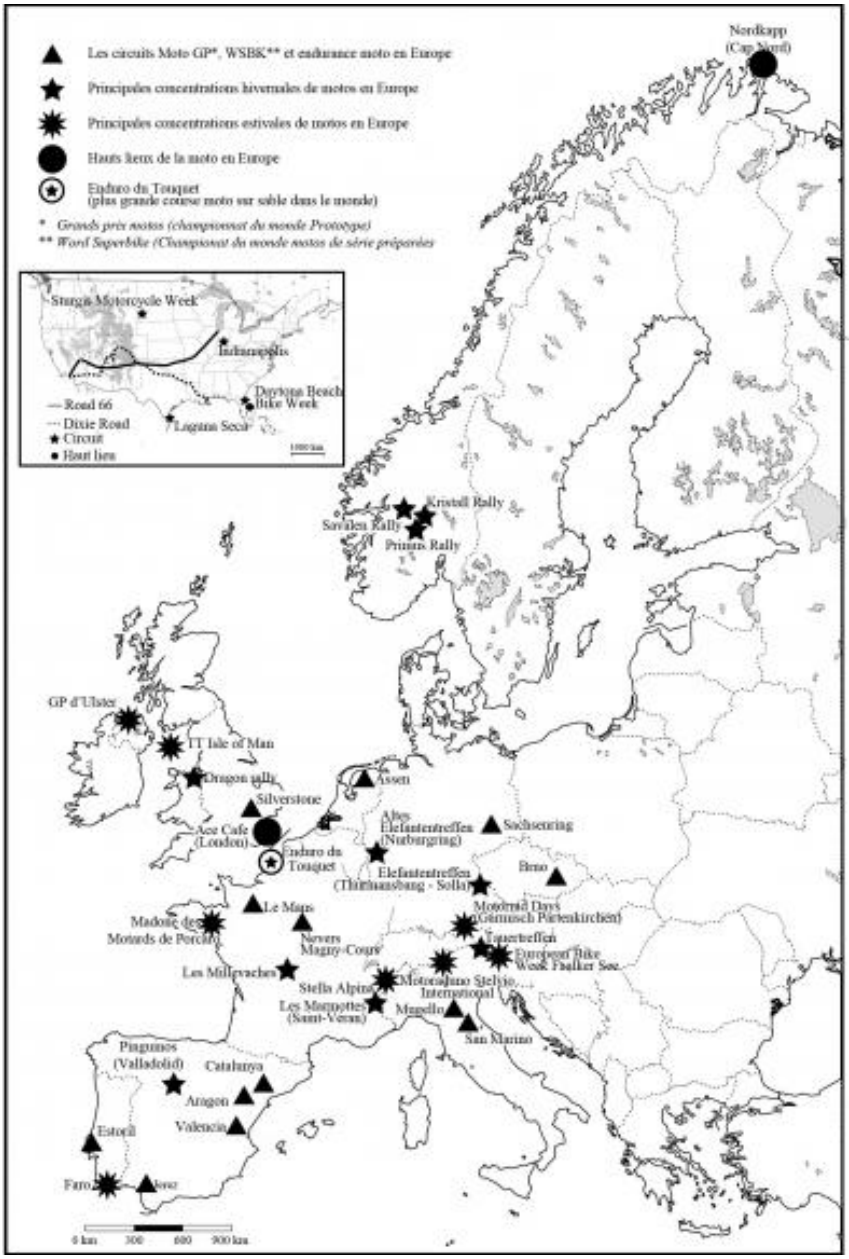


Figure 1. Some mythical places and roads of motorcycle tourism in Europe and North America
Note. Reproduced from "Motorcycle tourism: renewed geographies of a marginal tourism practice," by J. Scol, 2016, Via Tourism Review, 9, https://doi.org/10.4000/viatourism.356. Copyright 2016 by the author.

Appendix B

Survey introduction

The survey has been developed at the University of Dalarna in Sweden and is part of the research program International Tourism Management. With this study, I aim to examine and identify the key motivational factors underlying Dutch motorcycle tourists' participation in adventure tourism activities. I would be very pleased if you would take about 5 minutes of your time to complete the survey. All information that you give will be treated confidentially. Click the following link to see the information sheet for more details about the survey and data collection.

https://1drv.ms/w/c/85d88ce0bc757d92/IQCea2YE7pUKSZdAVZ8XTJXSAQ_niU1TZk5wkTqo_od97HU?e=bdFWro

Permission and Informed Consent
By completing this survey I give my consent to the research program to use the data I provide for research purposes, on the understanding that that the information I supply cannot be traced back to me in the reports on this research.

Information Sheet (when the respondent clicked the link above)

What is the survey about? The popularity of motorcycling is growing, also in the Netherlands. There exist only limited studies about this field, and therefore, this research would like to address this. More specifically, this study aims to examine and identify the key motivational factors underlying Dutch motorcycle tourists' participation in adventure tourism activities. Your answers to the survey help me collect information about key motivational factors and see what motivations hang together.
Who should take part? The target group of this survey includes Dutch motorcyclists who have experience with motorcycling holidays.
How long will it take? The survey takes around 5 minutes to complete.
Do I have to take part? No, taking part is entirely voluntary. We would encourage you to take part as the more participants there are, the more robust the research – but there is no obligation. *If you do take part, you will be asked to confirm your consent at the start of the survey.*
What data does the survey collect? In this survey you will be presented several questions out of different topics. The survey starts by asking a few demographic questions (e.g., age, gender, etc.) and will be followed by questions regarding your motivation to go for a motorcycle holiday. Hereby you are asked to fill in how important each statement is. The survey is not collecting any personal data.

What happens to the data? The processing of data in research is regulated by the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR). The data will be aggregated to a group level, analysed and published for scientific purposes, such as research papers, reports, and articles. No individual responses to the survey will be made public. The data will be used for research purposes only.

Read more in the Dalarna University guide on personal data and data protection (in Swedish)

Whom can I contact if I have queries or concerns about the survey? In case of any questions, please send an email to Mr. Contact Person: h23sispi@du.se

Survey questions

Demographic Information

* mandatory question (filtering question)

1. What is your gender?
   Male
   Female
   Other
2. What is your age ……?
3. Do you have a Dutch nationality?*
   Yes
   No
4. Have you ever made one or more motorcycle trips?*
   Multi-day ride including overnight stays
   Yes
   No
5. What is your preferred travel destination (country) for a motorcycle holiday ……?
6. What type of motorcycle do you mainly travel with?
   Adventure / Dual-sport
   Naked bike/ Roadster
   Sport bike
   Touring
   Cruiser
   Other:……
7. What type of accommodation do you usually choose during your motorcycle trips?
   Multiple answers possible
   Hotel/motel
   Camping
   Hostel

Airbnb / holiday rental

With friends or family

Self perception

8. I see myself as an adventurous person (Likert scale)
   Strongly disagree

   Disagree

   Neither agree nor disagree

   Agree

   Strongly agree

Travel motivation for Motorcycle Tourism

How important are the following motivations?

Note: the scale consists of 7 categories

Answer options based on a Likert scale of 1 – 7 of importance:

(Not important at all – not very important – slightly important – neutral – moderately important – very important – extremely important)

9. Interaction with nature and appreciation of beauty
10. Adrenaline/excitement
11. Enjoyment in sharing motorcycling with others
12. Overcoming challenges to reach difficult goals
13. A change from routine of home or work
14. Maintain physical and mental control of one's body
15. Using expertise to perform very difficult tasks
16. Activity as spiritual experience
17. Overcoming fear
18. Perception of motorcycling as artistic
19. Danger as a direct motivation
20. Enhancing how one is perceived by others
21. Motorcycling simply as a way to keep physically fit
22. Competition against others

Appendix C

Gender differences among motivation items

1 = male, 2 = female

Group Statistics

	Gender_1	N	Mean	Std. Deviation	Std. Error Mean
Interactionwithnatureandappreciationofbeauty	1.00	61	5.51	.766	.098
	2.00	30	5.83	.747	.136
Adrenalineexcitement	1.00	61	4.64	1.141	.146
	2.00	30	4.50	.900	.164
Enjoymentinsharinganmotorcyclingwithothers	1.00	62	4.90	1.399	.178
	2.00	30	5.20	1.064	.194
Overcomingchallengestoreachdifficultgoals	1.00	62	4.29	1.372	.174
	2.00	30	4.13	1.502	.274
Achangefromroutineofhomeorwork	1.00	62	5.18	1.064	.135
	2.00	30	5.30	1.149	.210
Maintainphysicalandmentalcontrolofonesbody	1.00	62	5.16	1.074	.136
	2.00	30	5.33	1.422	.260
Usingexpertisetoperformverydifficulttasks	1.00	62	4.63	1.231	.156
	2.00	30	4.23	1.501	.274
Motorcyclingasspiritualexperience	1.00	62	3.45	1.870	.238
	2.00	30	3.97	1.564	.286
Overcomingfear	1.00	62	3.32	1.566	.199
	2.00	30	3.97	1.474	.269
Perceptionofmotorcyclingasartistic	1.00	62	3.24	1.637	.208
	2.00	29	3.48	1.326	.246
Dangerasadirectmotivation	1.00	62	2.63	1.517	.193
	2.00	30	2.27	1.311	.239
Enhancinghowoneisperceivedbyothers	1.00	62	2.52	1.479	.188
	2.00	30	2.77	1.851	.338
Motorcyclingsimplyasawaytokeepphysicallyfit	1.00	62	3.85	1.556	.198
	2.00	30	3.83	1.464	.267
Competitionagainstdothers	1.00	62	2.23	1.384	.176
	2.00	30	1.87	1.074	.196